

Bandit Level 12 → Level 13

This level contains a file that has been **compressed multiple times**. We need to extract it step by step.

Step 1: Create a temporary folder

Run:

```
cd /tmp
mkdir bandit12
cd bandit12
```

Copy the file:

```
cp ~/data.txt .
```

Convert it back from hex:

```
xxd -r data.txt data.bin
```

A terminal window screenshot showing the execution of the commands for Step 1. The prompt is 'bandit12@bandit:~\$'. The commands and their outputs are: 'cd /tmp' (no output), 'mkdir bandit12' (no output), 'cd bandit12' (no output), 'cp ~/data.txt .' (no output), 'xxd -r data.txt data.bin' (no output), and 'file data.bin' (no output).

```
bandit12@bandit:~$ cd /tmp
bandit12@bandit:/tmp$ mkdir bandit12
bandit12@bandit:/tmp$ cd bandit12
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ cp ~/data.txt .
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ xxd -r data.txt data.bin
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ file data.bin
```

Step 2: Start extracting

Check the file type:

```
file data.bin
```

Rename it based on the compression type and extract it.

For example:

```
mv data.bin data.gz
gzip -d data.gz
```

```
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ mv data.bin data.gz
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ gzip -d data.gz
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ file data
data: bzip2 compressed data, block size = 900k
```

Then check the new file:

file data

Continue renaming and extracting according to the file type:

mv data data.bz2

bzip2 -d data.bz2

```
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ mv data data.bz2
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ bzip2 -d data.bz2
```

Then:

mv data data.tar

tar -xf data.tar

```
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ mv data data.tar
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ tar -xf data.tar
```

Keep using `file` to identify the next format and extract it until you finally get an **ASCII text** file.

Step 3: Find the password

After the final extraction, run:

file data*.bin

Then read the ASCII text file using:

cat data9.bin

```
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ ls
data.tar  data2.bin  data4.bin  data6.bin  data8.bin
data.txt  data3.bin  data5.bin  data7.bin  data9.bin
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ file data*.bin
data2.bin: bzip2 compressed data, block size = 900k
data3.bin: gzip compressed data, was "data4.bin", last modified: Wed Jun 24 14:58:
58 2026, max compression, from Unix, original size modulo 2^32 20480
data4.bin: POSIX tar archive (GNU)
data5.bin: POSIX tar archive (GNU)
data6.bin: bzip2 compressed data, block size = 900k
data7.bin: POSIX tar archive (GNU)
data8.bin: gzip compressed data, was "data9.bin", last modified: Wed Jun 24 14:58:
58 2026, max compression, from Unix, original size modulo 2^32 49
```

You should get:

The password is qYQiHOBPR8zR61qxYqX45quvihF2uzk

Password for Level 13: qYQiHOBPR8zR61qxYqX45quvihF2uzk

Then exit from the level.

```
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ cat data9.bin  
The password is qYQiHOBPR8zR61qxYqX45quvihF2uzk  
bandit12@bandit:/tmp/bandit12$ exit  
logout
```